



Introduction to the Bible

The Bible is a collection of some of the best stories ever told. For hundreds of years they have been familiar to many readers. The stories themselves are full of fascinating characters and exciting incidents and I have tried to tell them in ways that young children can find easy to understand. However, the Bible is different from other story collections. Not all of these retellings are happy, some are sad or even frightening. Therefore you may want to read each of the stories for yourself before reading them aloud. In this way you will be ready for any questions that might arise.

The Old Testament

The Old Testament stories are full of heroes like Noah, Abraham, Moses, and Daniel, who had a special relationship with God. Some, like

Jonah, were reluctant heroes and had to be persuaded by strong means.

These stories are also full of vivid pictures—the glorious garden of Creation, the pairs of animals being marshaled into the ark, Joseph's coat of many colors. Some images are

disturbing in their power, like Adam and Eve being banished from Eden, the near-sacrifice of Isaac by his father, and the lions who ate Daniel's accusers. But they are as much a part

of the Bible as the more comforting imagery of creation, repentance, and salvation.

